patterns vary in the digital sphere, how other parties tried to replicate its online successes and why they failed, and, finally, how much digital really does matter. Simultaneously, the BJP launched the largest membership drive India has seen by a national party since the pre-Independence Congress. It restructured management oversight systems to create a deep ground organisation base at the voting-booth level with the aid of digital technologies that allowed greater precision than ever before. These methods differ from what has been deployed by other political bodies, and is at the heart of what helped turn the BJP into the world's largest political party.

Part III examines the role of ideology and governance. It examines the BJP's major ideological touchpoints—its anti-Congress-ism, its strident criticism of Nehru, its unifocal attention on the Kashmir question, the driving impulses of recent debates like the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019 (CAA)—which, at their core, are also about the place of Hindus and Muslims in a democratic India from a historical perspective. It reconstructs the prehistory of these debates in the 1950s, linking them with what came before the BJP: the Jan Sangh. Many of India's current political debates are exact replicas of the debates that started back then. This section shows why these arguments did not win elections for decades, and what changed so that they became politically potent.

This section also examines the BJP's economic thinking at a time when India's high growth rates seem to have become a feature of the past, especially after the disruptions of COVID-19. It examines whether there is a Modi/BJP model of economics, and if it is different from the economic model of the last BJP government led by Atal Bihari Vajpayee. Furthermore, it examines some of the policies of the state governments that the party leads to more closely comprehend this economic model.

The BJP cannot be understood without an understanding of the RSS. Part IV examines the RSS, how it has expanded in the last few decades, what it stood for by 2020 (as opposed to its positioning a decade ago), its role in social mobilisation, and specific measurable connections between the BJP and the RSS at the personnel level. In particular, it studies the BJP–RSS linkages in the Modi government, in the party nationally and in a state-level regime in Madhya Pradesh